Muhammad Saqib Bilal

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Senior Full Stack Developer

TypeScript | React | Next.js | Laravel (API-First) | PostgreSQL | RESTful APIs | Docker | AWS

Summary: Senior Full Stack Developer with 6+ years of experience focused on building scalable, API-first applications. Expert at modernizing legacy PHP monoliths into decoupled, API-first ecosystems using React, Next.js 15, TypeScript, and Laravel 12. Proven expertise in AI integration (Semantic Search) and cloud-native deployments on AWS (ECS/Fargate)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend & Security: PHP 8.4, Laravel 12 (Headless), Sanctum (Bearer Token Auth), RESTful API Design, TDD (Pest/PHPUnit)

Modern Frontend: Next.js 15 (App Router, SSG/ISR), React 19, TypeScript, Zustand, TanStack Query, Tailwind CSS

AI & Search: Google Gemini API (Embeddings), PostgreSQL (pgvector), Semantic Similarity Search.
DevOps & Cloud: AWS (ECS/Fargate, ALB, RDS, S3), Docker, GitHub Actions (CI/CD), Linux CLI
Testing: Pest, PHPUnit, Vitest, Xdebug, TDD.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Apricot Inc. – Toronto, Canada — *11/2024 – Present*

Senior Full Stack Engineer

- Architected a decoupled Laravel 12 / Next.js 15 ecosystem, implementing SSG/ISR to reduce page load times by 60% and successfully transition the organization from legacy Blade templates to an API-first model.
- Reduced redundant API overhead by 40% for PathLog (React 19 & Chrome Extension) by implementing TanStack Query caching and managing global state with Zustand.
- Secured cross-domain data exchange by implementing a stateless authentication layer using Laravel Sanctum and Bearer Tokens, ensuring secure communication between the headless backend and modern frontend
- Engineered an AI-powered semantic search feature using Google Gemini and pgvector, improving search relevance and accuracy by 35% compared to traditional keyword-based matching.
- Orchestrated cloud-native deployments on AWS ECS/Fargate via GitHub Actions, managing high-availability infrastructure including RDS (PostgreSQL) and Application Load Balancers (ALB)

Kalkomey – Toronto, Canada — *11/2021 – 10/2024*

Full Stack Developer

- Modernized payment infrastructure by integrating the Stripe API, handling complex billing logic and automated invoicing.
- Containerized development workflows using Docker Compose, significantly reducing environment inconsistencies across the engineering team.
- Boosted organic search visibility and Lighthouse performance scores by 25% through strategic SEO refactoring and the elimination of backend bottlenecks identified via Xdebug and Google PageSpeed Insights.
- Refactored legacy codebase modules to adhere to PSR-12 coding standards, improving long-term maintainability.

BID13 – Toronto, Canada *06/2020 – 09/2021*

PHP WEB DEVELOPER

- Reduced page load times by 40% through MySQL indexing and frontend asset optimization.
- Engineered fraud detection features using browser cookie tracking to prevent duplicate/fraudulent accounts.
- Developed location-based search functionality (Zip code/Distance search) for an online auction system.
- Collaborated with the frontend team to implement cross-browser compatibility fixes, ensuring a seamless and consistent bidding experience for users on both mobile and desktop platforms.

ZAMEEN MEDIA – Lahore, Pakistan *01/2019 – 02/2020*

SENIOR PHP (LARAVEL) BACKEND DEVELOPER

- Increased system reliability by 30% by implementing a TDD workflow with PHPUnit, achieving more than 80% code coverage and reducing production hotfixes for real-estate data synchronization services
- Integrated complex third-party REST APIs including Google Maps and Calendar for real-estate data synchronization.
- Utilized AWS S3 for cloud-based file storage and managed code reviews within an Agile/Scrum team.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

Bachelor of Science in Telecommunications
National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences | *Lahore, Pakistan*

Post Graduate Diploma in Computer Science
Virtual University of Pakistan | *Lahore, Pakistan*